

* DUP

The dup System call copies a file descriptor into the first free slot of the user file descriptor table, returning the new file descriptor to the user.

Syntax :

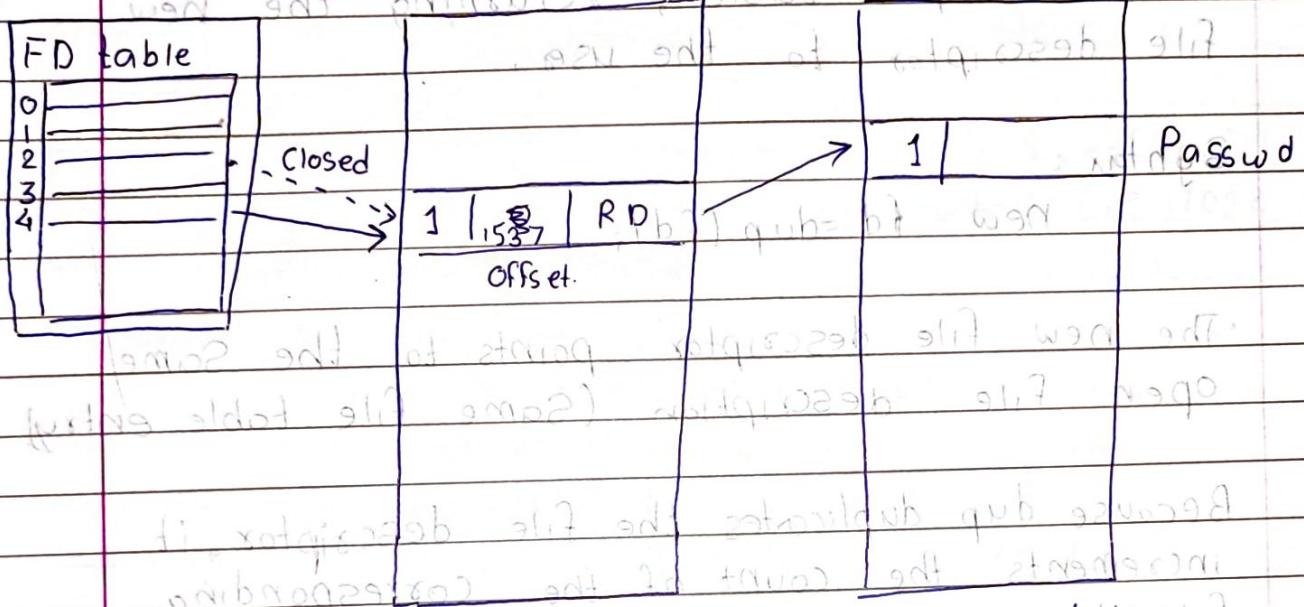
new fd = dup (fd);

- The new file descriptor points to the same open file description (Same file table entry)

Because dup duplicates the file descriptor, it increments the count of the corresponding file table entry, which now has one more file descriptor entry that points to it

ex.

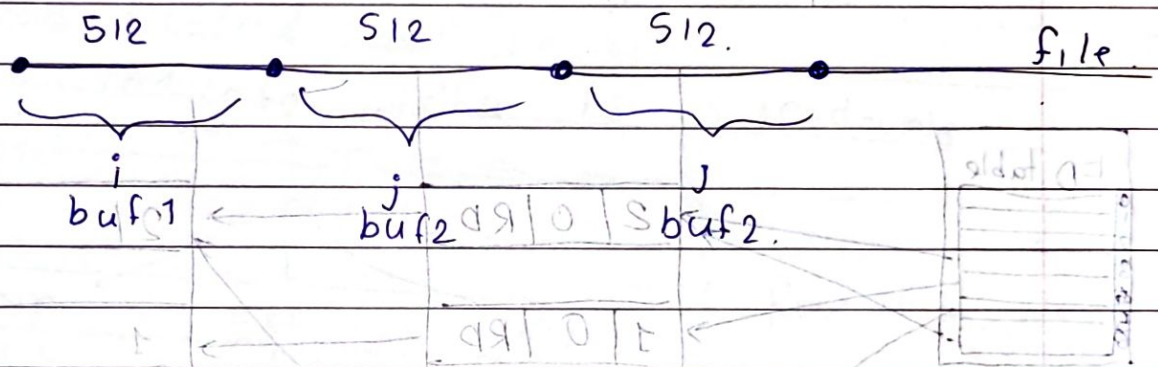
```
#include <fcntl.h>
int main()
{
    int i, j;
    char buf1[512], buf2[512];
    i = open("/etc/passwd", O_RDONLY);
    j = dup(i);
    read(i, buf1, sizeof(buf1));
    read(j, buf2, sizeof(buf2));
    close(i);
    read(j, buf2, sizeof(buf2));
}
```

- * **First Read** (`read (i, buf1, sizeof (buf1))`):
 - `i` and `j` share the same file offset (because `dup()` does not create a new file description, just a new descriptor pointing to the same underlying file).
 - `i` reads the first 512 bytes from `/etc/passwd`.
 - The offset moves forward by 512 bytes.
- * **Second Read** (`read (j, buf2, sizeof (buf2))`):
 - Since `j` shares same file offset with `i`, it starts after the first 512 bytes.
 - So, `buf2` will contain next 512 bytes from `/etc/passwd`, not same as `buf1`.

* On closing (i.e. `close(i)`) closing `i` does not affect `j`, because they are just references to same file.

* Third read (`read(j, buf2, sizeof(buf2))`)
 • It reads next 512 bytes (i.e. 1024-1536) of /etc/passwd.



* Open * Difference between `Open` and `dup()`
 • `Open` creates new entry in file table
 • `dup` does not create new entry.
 • In `open` reference count is incremented
 • In `dup` reference count is as it is but FD count is increased.
 • `Open` opens a new file and returns a file descriptor whereas `dup` duplicates an existing file descriptor.

* `dup2()`: It is an enhanced version of `dup()` that allows you to duplicate a file descriptor to a specific number.

`dup2(4, 1)`
 ↳ Close the 1st FD
 ↳ dup the FD to 4 pointing to file table entry

fd = open ("output.txt", O_WRONLY);

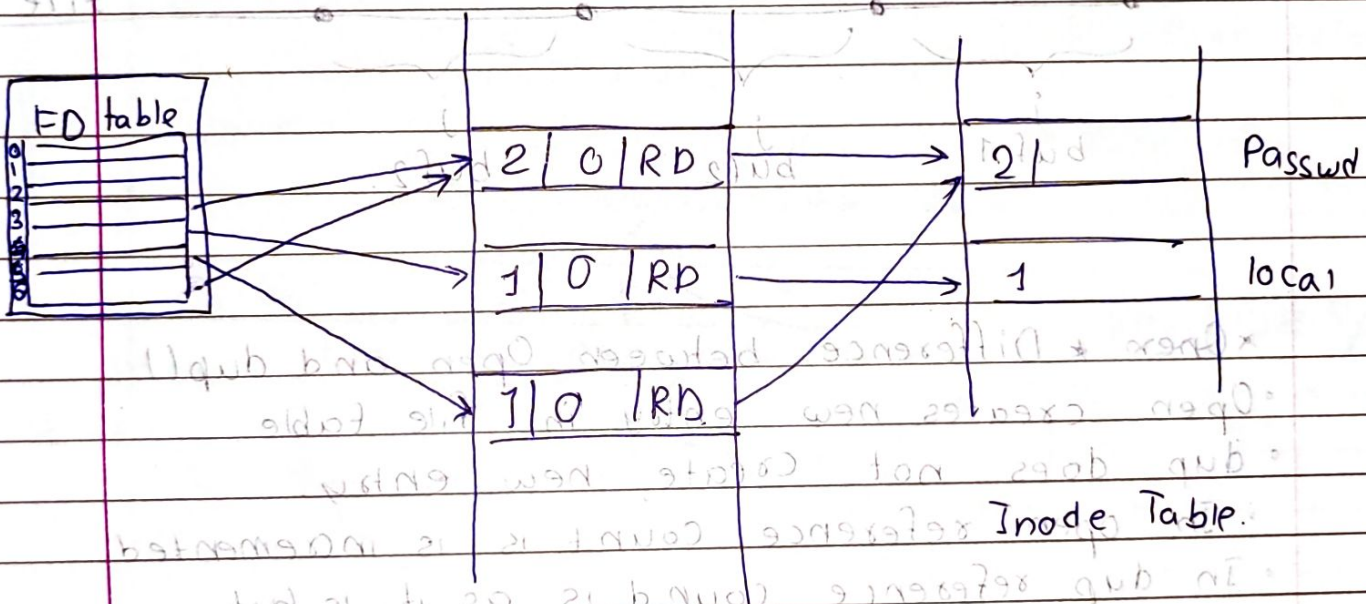
dup2 (fd, 1) redirects stdout (fd 1) to output.txt

fd1 = open ("./passwd", O_RDONLY);

fd2 = open ("./local", O_RDONLY);

fd3 = open ("./passwd", O_RDONLY);

fd4 = dup (fd1);



* Mounting and Unmounting File Systems.

The mount system call connects the file system in a specified section of a disk to the existing file system hierarchy.

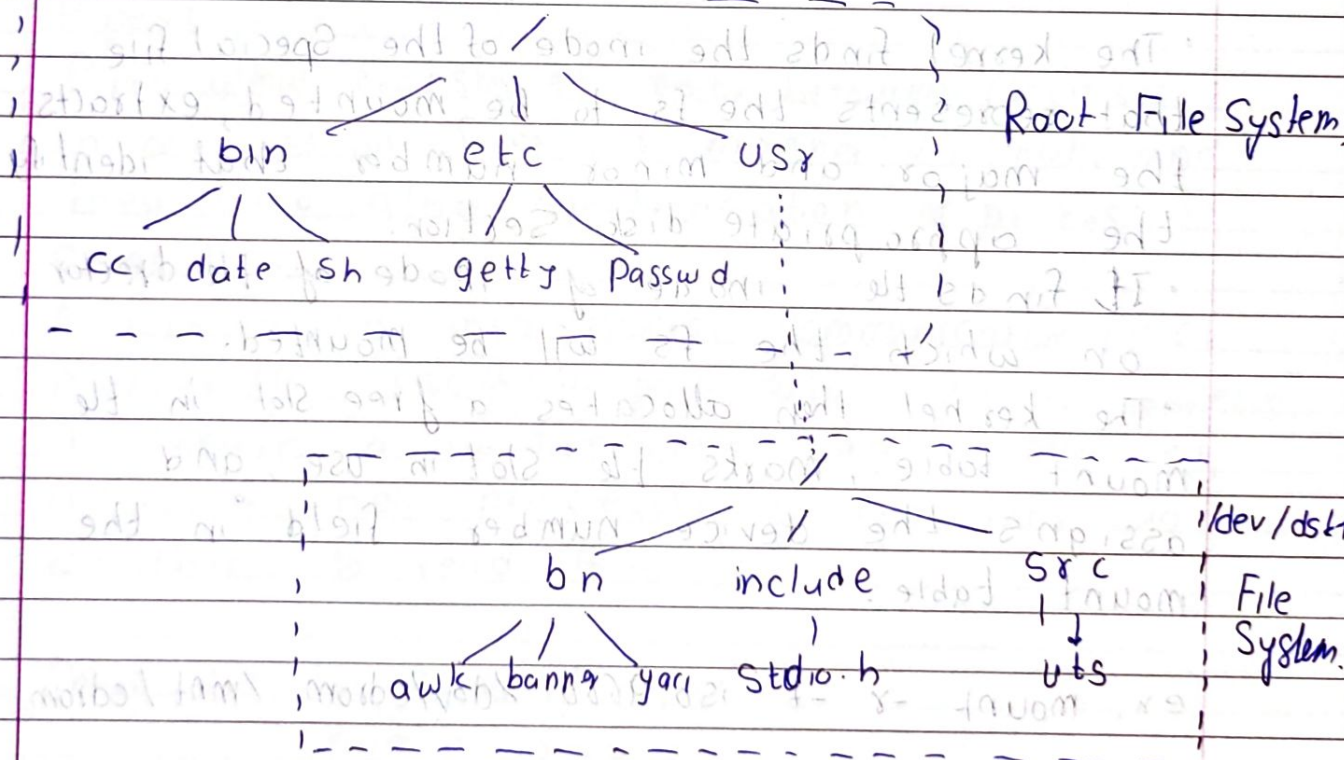
Unmount system call disconnects a file system from the hierarchy.

The mount system call thus allows us to access data in a disk section as a file system.

Syntax:

mount (Special pathname, directory pathname, options);

- where Special pathname is the name of the device special file of the disk section containing the fs to be mounted.
- directory pathname is the directory in the existing hierarchy where the fs will be mounted (called mount point).
- Options indicate whether fs is read-only.



FS Tree before & After mount

ex. mount (" /dev /dsk1", "/usr", 0);

The kernel attaches the fs contained in the portion of the disk called "/dev /dsk1" to directory "/usr" in the existing file system tree

The kernel has a mount table with entries for every mounted file system.

Each mount table entry contains:

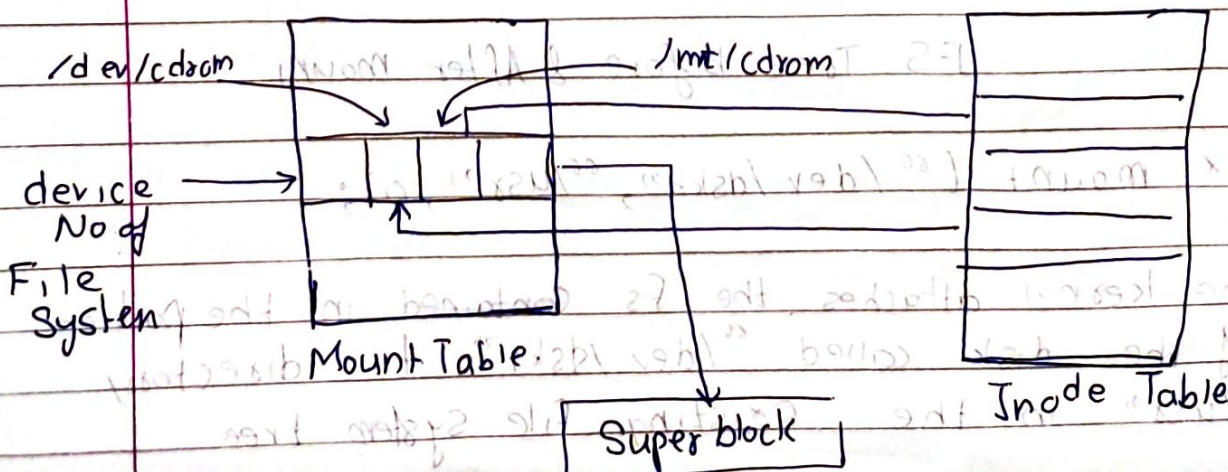
- a device no that identifies the mounted fs.
- a pointer to a buffer containing the fs Super block.
- a pointer to the root node of mounted fs.
- a pointer to inode of directory that is the mount point.

• The kernel finds the inode of the Special file that represents the fs to be mounted, extracts the major and minor number that identify the appropriate disk section.

• It finds the inode of the director on which the fs will be mounted.

• The kernel then allocates a free slot in the mount table, marks the slot in use, and assigns the device number field in the mount table.

ex. `mount -t iso 9660 /dev/cdrom /mnt/cdrom.`



→ Mounts in read only mode
-t iso9660 → Specifies fs type ISO 9660
(Used for CDs / DVDs)
/dev /cdrom → device file representing CD Rom.
mnt /cdrom → mount point

- Q Name of PCB in linux → task_struct
Q Name of file table → Open file table
Q Name of mount table → fs tab (/etc /fstab)

* Pipes:

- Pipes allow transfer of data between processes in a first-in-first out manner (FIFO), and they also allow synchronization of process execution.
- A pipe is an inter-process communication (IPC) mechanism used to pass data between processes.
- It creates a unidirectional data channel, allowing one process to write data and another to read it.
- There are two kinds of pipes:
 - named pipes
 - unnamed pipes.
- Processes use open system call for named pipes, but the pipe system call to create an unnamed pipe.

- Afterwards, processes use the regular system calls for files, such as read, write, and close when manipulating pipes.

- Only related processes (descendants of a process that issued the pipe call) can share access to unnamed pipes.

- However, all processes can access a named pipe regardless of their relationship.

* Pipe System Call

Syntax:

```
pipe(fdptr);
```

where `fdptr` is the pointer to an integer array that will contain the two file descriptors for reading and writing the pipe.

- The `pipe()` system call is used to create a unidirectional communication channel between two processes, allowing one process to write data and another to read it.

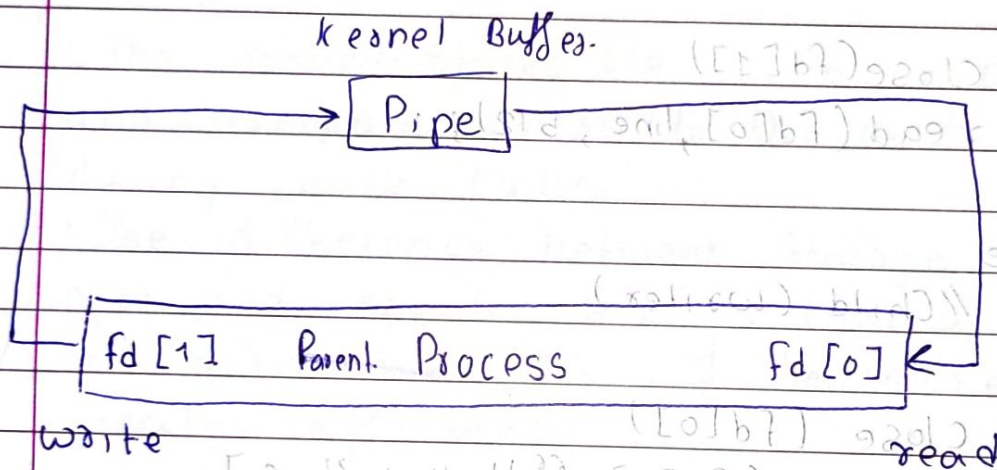
`fd[0]` — read end of the pipe

`fd[1]` — write end of the pipe.

- The kernel assigns an inode for a pipe using `alloc`.

- The kernel then allocates two file table entries for the read and write descriptors, respectively, and updates the bookkeeping information in inode.

- Each file table entry records how many instances of the pipe are open for reading or writing,
 - * initially 1 for each file table entry.
- Inode reference count indicates how many times the pipe was "opened", initially two - one for each file table entry.



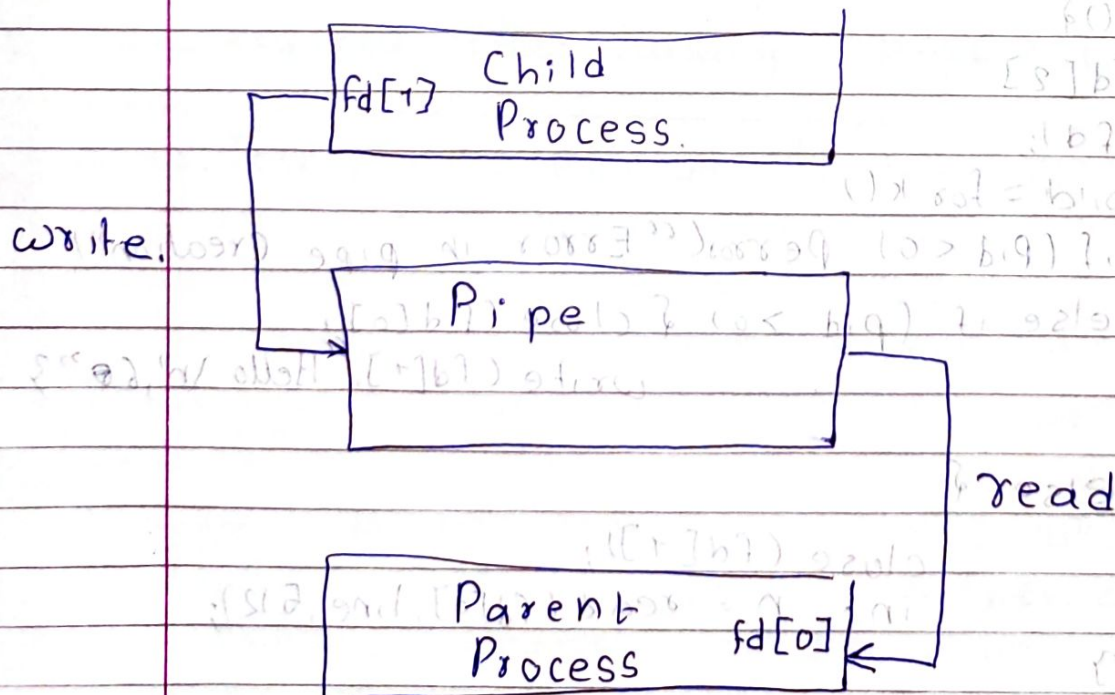
* Transfer data from parent to child.

```

int main() {
    int fd[2];
    pipe(fd);
    int pid = fork();
    if (pid < 0) perror("Error in pipe creation");
    else if (pid > 0) { close(fd[0]);
        write(fd[1], "Hello\n", 6);
    }
    else {
        close(fd[1]);
        int n = read(fd[0], line, 512);
    }
}
    
```


Transfer data from Child to Parent

```
int main() {
    int fd[2];
    int char_line[512];
    pipe(fd);
    int pid = fork();
    if (pid < 0) {
        perror("Error in pipe creation");
    }
    else if (pid > 0) {
        // Parent (reader)
        close(fd[1]);
        read(fd[0], char_line, 512);
    }
    else {
        // Child (writer)
        close(fd[0]);
        write(fd[1], "Hello\n", 6);
    }
}
```



- * Reading and Writing in Pipes
 - A pipe should be viewed as if processes write into one end of the pipe and read from the other end.
 - Process access data from a pipe in FIFO manner, meaning that the order that data is written into the pipe is the order in which it is read from the pipe.
 - The kernel stores the data on pipe device and assigns blocks to the pipe as needed during write calls.
 - The difference between storage allocation for pipe and regular file is that a pipe uses only the direct blocks of the inode for greater efficiency.
 - When a process reads a pipe, it checks if the pipe is empty or not. If it contains data, the kernel reads data similar to regular files using `algoread`.
 - If a process attempts to read more data than is in the pipe, the read will complete successfully after returning all data, even though it does not satisfy the `usercount`.
 - If a process writes a pipe and pipe cannot hold all the data, the kernel marks the inode and goes to sleep waiting for data to drain by some `read()`. During read kernel will notice process that are asleep and waiting for data to drain and will awaken them.

- When writer process has written all the data, the kernel updates the pipe's (inode) write pointer so that next process can write the pipe from where the current finished.

* Closing Pipe

- When closing a pipe, a process follows the same procedure as for regular file, except that kernel does special processing before releasing the pipe's inode.
- The kernel decrements the number of pipe writers or readers.
- The kernel frees all its data block if count of writer and reader is 0 and no process are asleep.
- The kernel then indicates pipe is empty.

- `close()` function in pipe is used to close unused ends of the pipe, ensuring proper data flow and preventing deadlocks.

* `popen()` and `pclose()`

- The `popen()` function is used to execute a shell command and create a pipe to read its output or write input into it.
- The `pclose()` function closes the pipe and waits for the command to complete.

Syntax :

```
File * popen( const char * command, const char * mode );
```

```
File * Popen( const char * command, const char * mode );
```

```
int fclose( FILE * stream );
```

Command : Shell commands to execute

modes - "r" read from command's output

- "w" write to command's input

• Returns A File pointer to interact with process

Working of popen

1. Creates a pipe

2. Fork.

3. In Child,

Closes unnecessary file descriptors

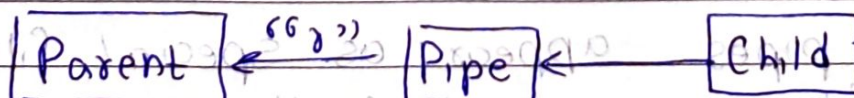
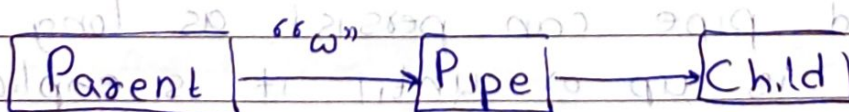
- executes command using `exec()`

↳ In parent

- returns File* Stream that

can be used with `fgets()`, `fputs()`

- Close unused end of pipe




```
int main()
```

```
{
```

```
File * fp; //file pointer
```

```
fp = popen("/bin/ls", "r") //Command to exec
```

```
char buffer[100];
```

```
while (fgets(buffer, sizeof(buffer), fp) != NULL)
```

```
printf("%s", buffer);
```

```
pclose(fp)
```

```
return 0;
```

```
}
```

* Output:

This code executes /bin/ls in child process and the output of this command is read through FILE and printed.

* Named Pipes (FIFO)

FIFO is a named pipe that allow IPC between unrelated processes.

Unlike pipe(), which only between parent-child processes.

FIFO enables communication between

separate processes.

While a traditional pipe exists temporarily, a named pipe can persist as long as the system is up or until it is explicitly deleted.

Named pipes appear as special files in the file system, and multiple processes can attach to them for reading and writing, facilitating inter-process communication.

- This file type is created using the `mkfifo()` system call in C.
- Once created, any process can open the named pipe for reading or writing, similar to ordinary file.

```
int mkfifo (pathname, mode);
```

Both `mkfifo` and `mknod` can be used to create a FIFO (Named Pipe).

1. `mkfifo`: It is specially designed to create named pipes.

```
mkfifo /mydir/myfifo.
```

2. `mknod`: It can create device file, FIFOs and other special files.

```
mknod /mydir/myfifo p 1 1 1
```

The `P` argument tells `mknod` to create a FIFO.

```
echo "Hello" > /mydir/myfifo // Writer
```

```
cat /mydir/myfifo // Reader
```

* Tee Command:

The `tee` command reads from standard input (stdin)

and writes to both standard output (Stdout) and a file (or multiple files) at same time.

ex. `ls -l | tee a.txt`
displays output of "ls -l" on terminal and saves to output.txt

`mkfifo fifo1`

`prog 3 < fifo1 &`

`prog 1 < infile | tee fifo1 | prog 2`

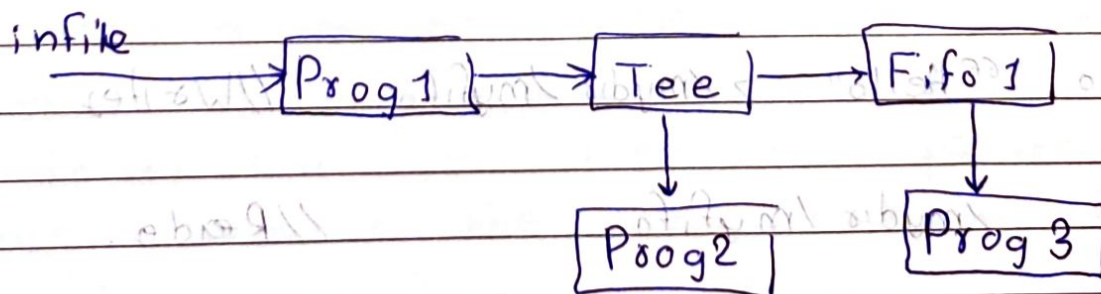
* `mkfifo fifo1` creates a named pipe `fifo1`

* `prog 3 < fifo1 &`

- Runs `prog3`, taking input from `fifo1`
- & at end runs in background so that next commands can proceed.

* `prog 1 < infile | tee fifo1 | prog 2`

- `prog 1 < infile`: Runs `prog 1` with input from `infile`.
- `| tee fifo1`: Sends output of `prog 1` to both `fifo 1` and `prog 2`.



`mknod [Options] name type major minor.`

ex

`mknod -m 620 /dev/p0 C 6 0`

name → Path where device file is created

type → device type.

• C → Char device

• b → block device

• p → Named pipe

Major → Major number (identifies the driver).

minor → Minor number (specific instance of the device)

`-m 620` → 6 → Owner → read & write

→ Group → write only.

→ 0 → Others → no permissions.

`mknod -m 620 /dev/p0 C 6 0`

`mknod -m 620 /dev/p1 C 6 1`

Other device.

Both `/dev/p1` and `/dev/p2` will be handled by the same driver. (Second instance of device)

• The driver will treat them as separate instances because the minor number is different.

* `ls -l` Command
It lists detailed information about device files in `/dev/`

`/dev/mem` - Contents of memory.

`/dev/kmem` - Contents of kernel's virtual memory.

`/dev/audio`

`/tty` - keyboard input (controlling terminal)

`/tty0` - Main virtual console (first terminal)

`/CPU` - CPU core info (`/dev/CPU/0/1`)

`/net` - network related virtual devices.

`/ram` - first ram disk

`/dsp` - direct sound processing device file for audio output

Q. When are device files created:

- At boot time. (detects hardware).
- When a device is plugged in. (ex USB).
- Manually using `mknod` (custom device).
- Loading a kernel module.
- While mount for pseudo-file system.

Q. What are device files used for.

- It acts as interface to hardware and virtual devices.
- They allow user-space program to communicate with hardware devices and software devices.

Q. What are major & minor number.

- It is used to identify device files in `/dev/`

Major no. identifies driver that handles the device.

Minor no. identifies instance of device handled by driver.

Major No is an index of Some Device array which contains pointers which points to Device Drivers certain functions

* Hard Link

A hard link is an additional name for a same inode (file data)

It directly points to the same file on the disk.

Array of Pointers
Pointing to f.n.

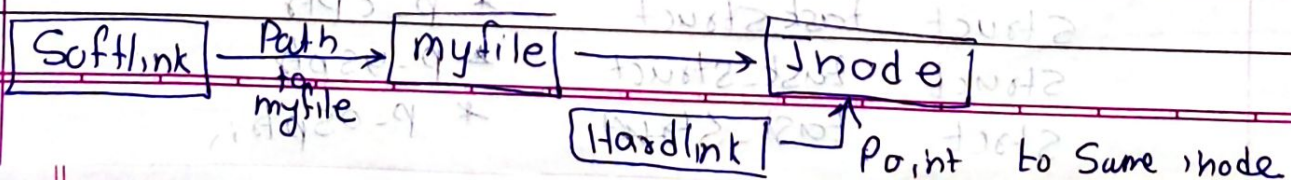
* Symbolic (Soft) Link

A Symbolic link is a special file that acts as a shortcut pointing into original file's path.

	Hard Link	Soft Link
Points to	Inode	File path
Inode No	Same as original	different from the original
works after deleting Original	Yes	No.

* In `~ /myfile /etc /Somedir /sm`
This command attempts to create a hard link from `~ /myfile` to `/etc /Somedir /sm`

In `-s` (Symbolic link).



* Process Control block

- In linux, the process Control block (pcb) is represented by the task_struct structure.
- This structure contains all the necessary information about a process, including its state, scheduling details, memory information etc.

struct task_struct.

volatile long state;

volatile long counter;

unsigned long priority // real time

unsigned long priority

unsigned long policy

unsigned long signal

unsigned long blocked;

struct long blocked

struct sigaction sigaction[32];

unsigned flags : PF_ALIGNWARN

PF_TRACED

PF_TRACESYS

PF_STARTING

PF_EXITING

int debug reg[8]

struct exec_domain * exec_domain

struct task_struct * next_task

struct task_struct * prev_task

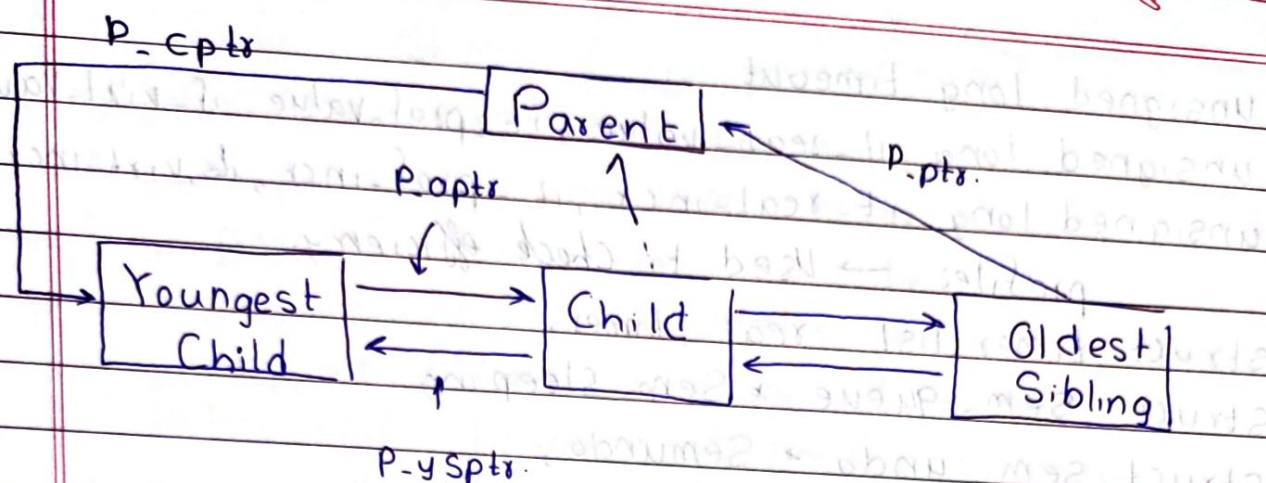
struct task_struct * p_opptr;

struct task_struct * p-pptr;

struct task_struct * p_cptr

struct task_struct * p-ysptr

struct task_struct * p-osptr;



```

struct mm_struct mm,
unsigned long kernel_stack_page;
unsigned long saved_kernel_stack;
pid_t pid, pgrp, session, tgid, leader;
unsigned short uid, euid, suid, fsuid;
unsigned short gid, egid, sgid, fsgid;
int groupset [NGROUPS];
struct fs_struct fs; → Structure related to
                        file system
                        int count;
                        unsigned struct unmask;
                        struct inode *root;
                        struct inode *pwd.
  
```

```

struct files_struct files
long utime, stime, cutime, cstime, starttime;
      ↑           ↑           ↑
      process    user      kernel
                mode      mode.
  
```


unsigned long timeout
 unsigned long it_real_value, it_prof_value, it_virt_value,
 unsigned long it_real_incr, it_prof_incr, it_virt_incr;
 profiles → Used to check efficiency.

struct timer_list real_timer;
 struct sem_queue * sem_sleeping
 struct sem_undo * semundo;
 struct wait_queue * wait_childexit
 struct rlimit rlim [RLIM_NLIMITS],

int errno
 int exit_code exit_signal
 char comm [11] // Stores names of process.
 unsigned long personality; PER_LINUX
 int dumpable → stored in core file.
 int did_exec
 struct desc_struct * idt // local descriptor table } for
 struct linux_binfmt * binfmt // Use by loader } indir.
 struct thread_struct tss

#if def SMP ...
 int processor, last_processor
 int lock_depth
 #endif

- State - State of the process
- Counter - Referent Count
- rt_priority - real time priority
- priority - General priority
- policy. (FIFO/RR/OTHER/BATCH) represents policy
- Signal: Signal number of process
- blocked - bitmask of blocked signals
- Sigaction[32] - Array of 32 Sigaction, each represent how the process handles a specific signal
- PF_ALIGNWARN: Used to warn about unaligned memory
- PF_TRACED: Indicates that the process is being traced
- PF_TRACESYS: Use to track system call made by a process
- PF_STARTING: Indicates process is in initialization phase
- PF_EXITING: Indicates that the process is exiting

(These Unsigned Flags define State or behavior of process)

debugreg[8]: An array of 8 debug registers used for hardware-assisted debugging

- exec_domain: Used for binary compatibility
- next_task: Points to next process
- prev_task → Points to the previous process in global task.
- p_optr (old parent ptr) → The original parent process before being reparented.
- p_pptr (Parent ptr) → Points to current parent
- p_cptr (child ptr) → Points to youngest child
- p_ysptr (Youngest Sibling ptr)
- p_osptr (older Sibling ptr)

- `mm_struct mm` - Points to memory descriptor (Memory Management)
- `kernel_stack_page`, `saved_kernel_stack`
These hold process kernel stack
- `User-space Stack`
• `Kernel-space Stack`
Saved kernel stack helps in context switch
- `pid_t pid` - Process id.
- `pgid_t pgid` - Process Group id.
- `Session id` - Session id, groups all processes in a session
- `Thread Group id` - Thread Group id (Shared among all threads of a process)
- `leader` → Indicates if this process is the leader of session.
- `uid_t uid` - Real user id
- `euid_t euid` - Effective user id
- `suid_t suid` - Saved set user id
- `fsuid_t fsuid` - File System User id.
- `gid_t gid` - ^{real} group id
- `egid_t egid` - effective group id
- `sgid_t sgid` - Saved group id
- `fsgid_t fsgid` - file system Group id
- `groupset [NGROUPS]` - Array storing additional group members
- `struct fs_struct *fs` - Contains file system related info
- `struct files_struct *files` - Stores file descriptors
(fd table)

* Process Execution time

- utime - user mode CPU time (User Space)
- stime - System mode CPU time (kernel Space)
- cotime - Cumulative User mode time of all child process
- cstime - Cumulative System-mode time of all child process
- Start time - The time when process started

* Process Timers (it* Fields)

- timeout - defines when process should be scheduled next
- it_real_value - Initial value of real-time timer
- it_prof_value - Time left for the profiling timer
- it_virt_value - Time left for virtual timer
- it_real_incr - Incr for real time timer
- it_prof_incr - Incr for profiling timer
- it_virt_incr - Incr for virtual timer

- profiler - Used for CPU profiling
- timer_list real_timer - The real-time timer

* Process Synchronization

- sem_queue - Points to Semaphore queue
- sem_undo - Used for undoing Semaphore operation
- wait_child_exit - Queue where a parent process wait for child to terminate

* Resource Limits (rlim[RLIM_NLIMITS])

- storg resource limits

* Process exit Information

`exit` - Stores last error code.

`exit_code` - The process exit status.

`exit_signal` - The signal sent to the parent.

* Process Identification

`comm [11]` - Stores names of process.

`personality` - Defines process behavior.

e.g. `PER_LINUX`, `PER_SVR4`

* Process Dumping

`dumpable` - Control whether process memory can be dumped.

* Execution Format

`exec` - Indicator if process executed normally.

`struct linux_binfmt` - Points to bin format handler.

e.g. `ELF` (Used by loader).

* Processor - Specific Fields

`desc_struct` - Interrupt Descriptor table.

`thread_struct` - Task State Segment.

* SMP (Symmetric Multiprocessing)

`int processor`

`last_processor` - Last CPU core used by process.

`lock_depth` - Last CPU core.

- depth of kernel locking.

(Spinlocks)

ELF - Executable & Linkable Format

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Date: / /

↳ In Linux / Unix,

created by compiler, assemblers and linkers.

Q What is file format of MySQL & Where is it stored?
/var/lib/mysql/

InnoDB engine .ibd

MyISAM engine - .MYI

Q Which is first process & created by whom.

init() - by kernel (After GRUB) start kernel() function.

Q ls -l /dev/mem

displays details about physical memory access device in linux.

-l long listing format (detailed info).